

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 25

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Mark Moffatt of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Mark Moffatt; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Moffatt was a renowned producer, guitarist, music businessman, and mentor whose legacy will continue to inspire those in Music City and beyond; and

WHEREAS, hailing from Maryborough, Queensland, Australia, Mark Moffatt moved to Brisbane, Australia, before relocating to the United Kingdom to work on London's Denmark Street for several years; and

WHEREAS, after returning to Brisbane in 1976, he, at the age of only twenty-five, was able to capture and craft the frenetic verve of the Australian punk band The Saints, producing "(I'm) Stranded," a song that ignited the punk music scene; thus, far away from The Clash or the Buzzcocks, Mark Moffatt harnessed a distinctly Australian brand of punk; and

WHEREAS, production stints with EMI and TCS Studios in Melbourne paved a way to Sydney in 1980, where Moffatt joined Festival Records as in-house producer, working with some of the biggest names in Australian music for more than a decade; throughout his career, Mark Moffatt continued to produce Australian artists across genres, from Yothu Yindi, who incorporated Aboriginal tradition with pop music, to New Wave artists such as Tim Finn; and

WHEREAS, upon moving to Nashville in 1996, he bridged the divide between Australia and Music City, mentoring his fellow Aussie Keith Urban and helping develop his career; and

WHEREAS, through the Australian performing rights organization APRA AMCOS, he helped Australian artists license and distribute their music in Nashville; he served as the organization's inaugural Nashville member relations representative until his retirement in June

2024; during his tenure in this capacity, he was awarded the Country Music Association's Global Achievement Award; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Moffatt was a founding member of the now-renowned Americana Music Association; he produced fifteen Australian Recording Industry Association Hall of Fame inductees and was behind more tracks than any other single producer in APRA AMCOS's list of the Top 30 Australian songs, published in 2001; and

WHEREAS, a true music man to the end, Mr. Moffatt was putting the finishing touches on an album for KILO, a band he formed with Australian singer John "Swanee" Swan, at the time of his passing; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his passion and devotion to music, Mark Moffatt was deeply committed to his family, most especially his wife, Lindsey; stepdaughter, Dana; son, Geordie; and two granddaughters; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Moffatt leaves behind an indelible legacy and a rich catalog that will forever remain touchstones of American and Australian music; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Mark Moffatt of Nashville, reflecting fondly upon his noteworthy career in music, his impeccable character, and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Moffatt.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.